

1.1. Definition and Purpose:

The following information is recommendation. You should use it wisely based on specific project needs and cases. Use it to find gaps, enrich or polish your existing processes or contracts

- What Is Change?
- Do's and don'ts
- Change Management Checklist
- Inputs
- Outputs
- Tips & Tricks

 Anchor | [whatischange](#)

2. What Is Change?

Change refers to any adjustment or deviation from the originally agreed-upon project scope, timeline, deliverables, or budget. These changes typically require formal evaluation, approval, and potential renegotiation, as they can impact project costs and resource allocations beyond the Fixed fee.

From customer's point of view - often this is just detailing the scope to a next level properly. For a customer it was 'obvious' that some business action needs additional sub-actions or integrations. They were not able to remember this all at once, or they were sure it's so 'obvious' that you should take it into account - doesn't matter. If you don't implement a really necessary feature in your application - business will never accept it.

When working with Fixed Scope/Budget Project changes are unlikely can be avoided and it's extremely important to keep them under control. The process needs to be setup at the earliest stage during Project Planning and presented as part of Project Governance. Change Management has to be well documented and approved by the customer in verbal or formal way.

From the very beginning and the first demo for the customer, you will receive feedback that will affect your scope. Changes don't necessarily mean addition to the scope, some small changes can be covered within the original estimate (like another font for the page before we start implementing a style guide). But it's still needs to be communicated to the customer as a change that will [not have]/[have] an impact on the project or require extra effort. Also such changes should be inline with SOW. It's highly recommended to make a list of such feedbacks and final solutions for each of them. It will help us to reach information about the type of feedback, priority, planned delivery dates, and any additional wishes from the customer regarding them.

Removal items from a Scope should also be recorded in the Change process. It can be left as a buffer for the customer to add something during a project, replaced with another item or filled in by improvement suggested by a team and approved by the customer.

Change Types:

- New Requirement
- Modification of the existing requirement
- Cancellation of the existing requirement

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3. Do's and don'ts

Do's:

1. **Do Establish Clear Objectives:** Clearly define the objectives and goals of the change initiative, ensuring that they align with the organization's overall strategy.
2. **Do Involve Stakeholders:** Engage stakeholders at every level and involve them in the change process. Their input and support are crucial for success.
3. **Do Communicate Proactively:** Develop a comprehensive communication plan that keeps stakeholders informed about the change. Address concerns and provide regular updates.
4. **Do Provide Training and Support:** Offer training and resources to help employees adapt to the change. Ensure they have the skills and knowledge they need.
5. **Do Address Resistance:** Anticipate resistance and proactively address it. Listen to concerns, provide rationale, and involve resistant stakeholders in the decision-making process.
6. **Do Start Small (if possible):** If the change is significant, consider piloting it in a smaller, controlled environment to learn from the experience and make adjustments.
7. **Do Monitor Progress:** Continuously track the progress of the change initiative against predefined milestones and key performance indicators (KPIs).
8. **Do Adapt and Learn:** Be flexible and willing to adjust the change plan based on feedback and evolving circumstances. Learn from challenges and successes.
9. **Do Recognize and Celebrate Success:** Acknowledge and celebrate achievements and milestones reached during the change process. This boosts morale and motivation.
10. **Do Document Lessons Learned:** After the change, document insights, challenges, and best practices to improve future change management efforts.

✖ Don'ts:

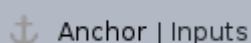
1. **Don't Agree** with changes without proper written confirmation and approval from the client's side.
2. **Don't Underestimate Impact:** Avoid underestimating how the change will affect different aspects of the organization. Conduct thorough impact assessments.
3. **Don't Ignore Stakeholder Concerns:** Avoid dismissing stakeholder concerns or feedback. Address their questions and involve them in finding solutions.
4. **Don't Neglect Communication:** Don't assume that communication is a one-time event. Consistent and transparent communication is key to managing uncertainty.
5. **Don't Overwhelm with Information:** Avoid overwhelming stakeholders with excessive information. Focus on providing relevant and concise updates.
6. **Don't Ignore the Human Element:** Remember that change affects people. Don't focus solely on technical aspects; consider the emotional impact as well.
7. **Don't Rush Implementation:** Avoid rushing into implementation without proper planning and testing. Rushed changes are more likely to encounter issues.
8. **Don't Ignore Feedback:** Don't ignore feedback or resistance from employees. They often have valuable insights that can improve the change process.
9. **Don't Focus Solely on Technology:** If the change involves technology, don't overlook the organizational and cultural adjustments required.
10. **Don't Neglect Training:** Don't assume employees will adapt without proper training. Inadequate training can lead to frustration and resistance.
11. **Don't Skip Evaluation:** Avoid skipping the evaluation phase after implementation. Assess the outcomes and whether the change met its objectives.

4. Change Management Checklist

1. Define Change:
 - Articulate purpose and nature of change
 - Identify goals, objectives, and expected outcomes
2. Assess Impact:
 - Determine scope and potential effects on project aspects
 - Analyze the impact on processes, systems, stakeholders, and resources
3. Stakeholder Analysis:
 - Identify affected stakeholders
 - Assess influence, interest, and potential resistance
 - Develop customized communication and engagement plan
4. Communication Strategy:
 - Create a communication plan addressing concerns, benefits, and expectations
 - Specify how and when stakeholders will be informed

5. Risk Assessment:
 - Identify potential risks and obstacles
 - Develop strategies to mitigate risks and address challenges
6. Test and Pilot:
 - Validate change in a controlled environment
 - Gather feedback and adjust based on pilot results
7. Implementation Plan:
 - Create a detailed rollout plan with timelines, responsibilities, and resources
 - Align with other ongoing projects and initiatives
8. Monitoring and Evaluation:
 - Establish KPIs to measure change success
 - Monitor and evaluate progress against KPIs
9. Feedback Mechanism:
 - Offer a channel for stakeholder feedback during and after implementation
 - Use feedback for continuous improvements
10. Continuous Improvement:
 - Review the post-implementation change management process
 - Identify lessons learned and areas for improvement for future efforts

5. Inputs/outputs



5.1. Inputs

1. **Change Request or Proposal:**
 - A document outlining the details of the proposed change, including its purpose, scope, objectives, and expected outcomes.
 - The change request should highlight the reasons for the change and its alignment with business goals.
2. **Impact Analysis:**
 - Assessment of how the change will affect various aspects of the organization, such as processes, systems, people, culture, and resources.
 - Identify potential risks, benefits, and challenges associated with the change.
3. **Stakeholder Identification:**
 - List of all individuals, teams, departments, and external parties that will be affected by the change.
 - Identify their roles, responsibilities, and level of influence in the change process.
4. **Stakeholder Analysis:**
 - Evaluation of stakeholders' attitudes, interests, concerns, and potential resistance to the change.
 - This analysis helps tailor communication and engagement strategies to address different stakeholder needs.
5. **Communication Plan:**
 - Detailed strategy for communicating the change to various stakeholders.
 - Outline the messages, channels, frequency, and timing of communication throughout the change process.
6. **Training Needs Assessment:**
 - Identification of the skills and knowledge gaps that need to be addressed through training.
 - Determine who needs training, what topics should be covered, and the preferred training methods.
7. **Risk Assessment and Mitigation Plan:**
 - List of potential risks and challenges that could arise during the change process.
 - Strategies for minimizing or mitigating these risks, along with contingency plans.
8. **Change Management Team:**
 - Formation of a dedicated team responsible for planning, executing, and overseeing the change initiative.
 - This team should include change champions, project managers, communication experts, and subject matter experts.
9. **Change Management Strategy:**

- High-level plan that outlines the approach, methodologies, and techniques that will be used to manage the change.
- This strategy should align with the organization's overall goals and culture.

10. Resources and Budget:

- Identification of the financial, human, and technological resources required for the change.
- Budget allocation for various activities such as communication, training, and stakeholder engagement.

11. Implementation Plan:

- Detailed timeline, milestones, and activities required for implementing the change.
- Assign responsibilities, set deadlines, and define deliverables for each phase of the change process.

12. Monitoring and Evaluation Metrics:

- Establishment of key performance indicators (KPIs) to measure the success of the change.
- Define how progress and impact will be monitored and assessed.

13. Feedback Mechanisms:

- Channels through which stakeholders can provide feedback, raise concerns, and ask questions during the change process.
- Include mechanisms for addressing and incorporating feedback.

 Anchor | output

5.2. Outputs

1. Change Management Plan:

- A comprehensive document outlining the overall approach, strategies, and tactics for managing the change.
- It includes details about communication plans, training schedules, stakeholder engagement, risk mitigation, and the implementation timeline.

2. Communication Materials:

- Various communication materials such as emails, newsletters, presentations, and videos used to inform and engage stakeholders about the change.
- These materials provide a consistent message and keep stakeholders updated on the progress.

3. Training and Learning Resources:

- Training materials, e-learning modules, workshops, and documentation created to equip employees with the skills and knowledge needed to adapt to the change.
- These resources support a smooth transition and minimize disruptions.

4. Stakeholder Engagement Reports:

- Documentation of interactions with stakeholders, including feedback, concerns, and questions raised during the change process.
- These reports help track stakeholder engagement efforts and address issues proactively.

5. Risk Assessment and Mitigation Records:

- Records of identified risks, their potential impact, and the strategies used to mitigate or address them.
- Documentation of any changes made to the mitigation plan based on actual risk occurrences.

6. Change Progress Reports:

- Regularly updated reports that track the progress of the change initiative against predefined milestones and timelines.
- These reports provide insights into whether the project is on track and identify areas that require adjustment.

7. Performance Metrics and KPIs:

- Data collected from key performance indicators (KPIs) that measure the success and impact of the change.
- These metrics help evaluate the effectiveness of the change and guide decision-making.

8. Lessons Learned and Best Practices:

- Documentation of insights gained throughout the change process, including successes, challenges, and areas for improvement.
- Capturing lessons learned helps refine future change management efforts.

9. Post-Implementation Review:

- Evaluation of the change initiative after its implementation, including a comparison of expected outcomes with actual results.
- This review helps determine the overall success of the change and informs adjustments for future initiatives.

10. Feedback Analysis:

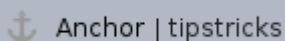
- Compilation and analysis of feedback from stakeholders to assess their satisfaction, concerns, and suggestions.
- This analysis informs continuous improvement efforts and enhances future change processes.

11. Knowledge Repository:

- A centralized repository of documentation, processes, and knowledge related to the change initiative.
- This repository helps maintain institutional memory and facilitates future reference.

12. Change Champions' Contributions:

- Reports or summaries of the efforts made by change champions and advocates to promote the change within the organization.
- Recognizing and appreciating these efforts can inspire future engagement.



6. Tips & Tricks

- Let the Customer and Team know that changes are welcomed and we are happy to do them, they just need properly go through the Change Management process. Implementing changes in a proper way may increase project budget and overall customer satisfaction.
- In cases when you have number of changes during period of time it worth to combine them into one CO. It can prepared per month basis as example.
- You may have uncertainty or miscommunication as a basis of change request. It's important to explain the customer at the beginning that everything that is not described or not specifically stated in original scope can be a change request.
- As a good practice to avoid Change Requests in a feature is to use Assumptions and Constraints when collecting/estimating requirements.
- When something important has to be fitted into original timeline without changing it. Offer the customer features candidates for substitution or propose to remove other feature with same effort from a scope. This gives the customer flexibility within the defined cost and schedule constraints. Both changes still have to be recorded, specially if they are changing what is stated in SOW.